

Island hot spots

Hot magma from inside the Earth can melt the thin oceanic crust and break through to the surface. These areas are known as hot spots. As the magma rises higher, it forms an underwater volcano. Repeated eruptions of magma can spread to form groups of volcanic islands.



The coastline on Kilauea volcano

FACT FILE

» **Location:** Central Pacific Ocean

» **Nationality:** American

» **Language:** Hawaiian, English



Hawaii

The Hawaiian Islands are dotted across 1,700 miles (2,700 km) of the Pacific Ocean. They formed as the ocean floor moved slowly over a hot spot. The Hawaiian volcano Kilauea is the world's most active volcano. It has been continuously erupting since 1983.

Iceland

This beautiful island developed from eruptions on the underwater mid-ocean ridge mountain chain millions of years ago. Iceland is one of the only places where the ocean ridge is dry land.

FACT FILE

» **Location:** North Atlantic Ocean

» **Nationality:** Icelandic

» **Language:** Icelandic



Iceland has about 30 active volcanoes.